# The Tree Mwata

## Performed by Muzee of Kanazi

Translated and edited by P.S.

Mwata, often called Omuti Mwata, The Tree Mwata, presents the further colorful exploits of the lake god Mugasha. In this story, his friendly alliance with the famous 17th-century ruler of Kyamutwala kingdom, Rugomora Mahe, presents an opportunity for adventure that has him stomping all over Hayaland. The mortal king is deeply troubled when a large tree is found that refuses to be chopped down by the cohort of workers he sends. With poetic boast and intransigent strength, the tree insultingly defies his will and power. The king sends emissaries to his friend Mugasha, who does the job with his characteristic humorous, rollicking, and world-altering style. In addition to his usual animal- and weather-spirit minions, the fisher-god brings along his powerful yet domestically capable wife Nyakalembe, "The Peaceful One," goddess of women's agricultural fertility. The tree is a place of sacrifice sacred to Wamala, the king of the gods, who Mugasha also battled in the heroic ballad that bears his name. There is a mythology of conflict and alliance between Mugasha, Wamala, and Rugomora Mahe that reflects strategic relationships among political groups in the development of the Haya royal state. (These are treated fully in Peter Schmidt's book Historical Archeology, Greenwood Press, 1978.) These enmities and alliances shape the world of the heroic ballad and give it mythic resonance, but drama and interest are carried by the bard's ability to create a rich tapestry of characters, settings, actions and, most of all, poetic speech. Muzee sang this ballad on August 21, 1969, at the house of Dionies Lutabanzibwa in Katome village, Kihanja, Kagera Region.

PLOT OUTLINE

**Lines 1-3.3:**
At night, the legendary king Rugomora Mahe lies tossing and turning and worrying about the spiritual state of his kingdom.

**Lines 4-23:**
At dawn, citizens appear and report wondrously strange events (lines 4-23); they are the result, perhaps, of some disruptive spiritual force.

**Lines 6.2-22.1:**
A snake behaves like a calf (lines 6.2-7), while lizards speak, asking about where to find beer and taunting warriors (lines 9-12). The king wonders and is instructed about the subject of serpents.

NOTES

1 These epithets refer to Rugomora Mahe, an early (c. 17th-century) king of Kyamutwara. His ascension to the throne is said to have rescued the kingdom from a long famine. The bard elaborates his epithet, "the writer-king," in another heroic ballad, *King Kahigi*, as "Rugomora, the writer of those who have ink" *Rugomora mpandiki eyabali kaino*. The ballad begins at night with the figure of a worried king, just as in the ballad *King Kaitaba*. The initial lines in both ballads introduce perceived threats to the throne. Rugomora's anxiety is about moral violations in his kingdom that may lead to supernatural turmoil.

2-3 The King sleeps fitfully, with his head toward Kihanja, to the southwest of his palace, and his feet toward Bujumba, to the northwest on the shore of Lake Victoria. Kihanja and Bujumba were part of the Greater Kyamtwara Kingdom that Rugomora ruled.

5.1 *Mafumbo* is a place in Kyamtwara near the lake. Because of the wondrous events that occur there, this ballad is sometimes entitled *Mafumbo*, or *The Tree of Mafumbo*.

10 *Munya lizard . . . startler of warriors . . . is your heart still in your chest?* This lizard proverbially inspires fear because of its resemblance to a snake. They say, *Omulumwa w'enjoka yekenga omunya*, The person bitten by a snake is cautious of the munya lizard.

15 *Kimuli* was the most beloved son of King Kalemera, an ancestor of Rugomora Mahe. Kimuli's murder set in motion a chain of events that led to the desolation of the kingdom and its ultimate rescue by Rugomora. Kimuli's spirit medium is said to have administered an oath of poison (see *Mugasha* I: 113),

He lay and he dreamed, the *Proclaimed one of Ibale,the Writer-king*.
His head faced Kihanja, the *King of others*.
His feet faced Bujumba
He said, "All the earth weighs on me.
If it isn't an illicit fetus in a pregnant miss,
It's an errant heifer."
As the servants washed him at dawn,
Men suddenly appeared.
They had come from Black-spot in Mafumbo.
"Long life to the Fearless-one, Father of men!"
He answered , "Dawn came in peace."
One of the men said, "There is no peace.
We've come to you to search for it, *Proclaimed one* of Ibale.

In Mafumbo there's a serpent
That goes out to pasture like a calf.
In Kihanja kingdom there are marvels."
"Also at my home on the mountain," said Kato.
"There is an *ekikomakome* lizard basking in the sun.
'You sir,' it says, 'Where can I find beer?'
'For beer ask the *munya* lizard.
I don't know this village so well.'
The *Startler of warriors* asks, 'What's wrong?
Is your heart still in your chest?'
'Tell me about serpents.
Tell me about the serpents of Bugonzi River.'
'There's *"Do it or don't; they'll not kill you"* of Kimuli Ngundu's shrine.
There's the *lujalanga* serpent
My lord, and the serpent of the spirit Kashasila at Rwanda village.
There's the spitting cobras of Binengo island.
Spit the white on me–
The black brings leprosy.
Don't make my body unclean.
Inside are the *lugondo* serpents,
Little white ones that snatch the heart away.
There are serpents of love inside that do no harm.
And serpents that . . . '"

which may account for the name of the serpent associated with his shrine.

Yanyiama yalota, *Ndangwa ya Ibale, Omukama Mpandiki*

Omutwe gulebile Kihanja, *Omukama w'abandi*
Amagulu galebile Bujumba
Ati, "Ensi yasikila yona
Kalaba atalimu mwisiki wa nsinjo
Alimu ente y'ensigaizi."
Kababaile mbanabula bwankya
Ayechula abashaija
Baluga Bwilagula Mafumbo
"Enshongole malama, Ishe abashaija!"
Ati, "Bwakya milembe."
Ati, "Emilembe teliyo
Twizile kugihiga aliwe, *Ndangwa ya Ibale.*

Enjoka eli Mafumbo
Netula nka enyana z'ente
Kihanja byaba bitangalo
Ati Nanye omwange aibanga Kato
Aliyo ekikomakome Nkyota omushana
'Iwe mushaija ondage amalwa.'
'Amalwa ogabaze Munya
Inye tikwekomya bya mukyalo'
Lukanga emanzi obaileki?
Omwoyo gukuli omukishenge?
Ngambila enjoka
Ngambila enjoka za Bugonzi
Alimu *Kikole kileke batakwita* egyo gashani ya Kimuli ngundu
Alimu enjoka Lujalanga
Waitu njoka ya Kashasila Lwanda

Alimu enchwela Binengo
Onchwele agalikwela
Agalikwilagula gabembesa
Otanyagalaza lugingo
Omunda alimu eza lugondo
Obujoka obulikwela obwa Kamuyaya
Alimu obujoka bw'engonzi obutashasa
Mbwo bujoka bwako...

21 The *lugondo* spirit is the soul spirit, a vector of one's desire, embodying its orientation and strength.

PLOT OUTLINE

**Lines 23-28.2:**
The king sends the men to Mafumbo to sacrifice to the spirit connected to the snakes that dwell there.

**Lines 29-44:**
They arrive at dusk and make their sacrifices (lines 29-30). At dawn they discover a giant tree, and they decide to report it to the king. They envision and enumerate the uses it can serve.

NOTES

34 These are praise epithets for Rugomora Mahe. *Enkuku* beans are associated with royalty.

When they reported this to him,
[He took some butter made from . . .]
He took some butter made from new-milk
Of a heifer cow,
  Two nines of *mabona* berries,
  And eight strings of cowries.
"Go and sacrifice at Mafumbo," he said,
"Sacrifice to the ebony serpents of Black-spot in Mafumbo–
  At Kitabi, Mujunwa, and Kashaka–
  Serpents that cause leprosy of Nyakalanda.

They arrived there as the cows came home,
  The time a guest arrives–at dusk.
They sacrificed at Black-spot in Mafumbo.

  When night gave way to dawn's first light,
  Out in the garden they were washing sleep from their eyes.
They saw a tree, my friend,
  Its crown and branches spread way up above,
  Its belly thin and straight,
  And never had it shed a single splinter.

"Let's betray its secret to *Proclaimed one of Ibale*,
*Bast that keeps* enkuku *beans from insect blight*,
  *Little palm, cut from Mikoni.*
*From Makes-shields-laugh and Fighter of Kikabuzi and Nyamwanja.*"
'My lord,' we'll say, 'the tree at Mafumbo–
In Kihanja it can be adzed out for you
My lord, into a lake canoe,
My lord, of paddles nine times two.
And into another for the rushing Ngono River,
Of canoe poles nine times two.
Let them adze out a fermentation vat–
In Kihanja it can be filled with mash for you.
Let them adze out a drum, and let it roar.
In Kihanja it would reach Bujumba.'"

Olwo bamugambile
[Yagila amajuta g'eilola limo g'ente yensigaizi amachu-]
Yagila amajuta g'eilola limo
G'ente y'ensigaizi
  Amabona myenda ebili
  Ensimbi yatunga munana
(Mugende mugabile Mafumbo)
Mugabile enjoka ilikwilagula eza Bwilagula Mafumbo

  Kitabi na Mujunwa na Kashanzo
  Njoka ibembya za Nyakalanda

Bagobamu ente nitaha
  Mbali omugenyi agobela bwaigolo
Bagya bagabilila Bwilagula Mafumbo

  Kabwile bwasingile bukyakya
  Mbanaba amaizi g'eiko omukibanga

Babona omuti baba
  Gwalela engoto namashanju
  Akalega tigukalyaga
  Tigukejulaga nkonjo

Tugulegele *Ndangwa ya Ibale*
*Byai nakoma enkuku iyabungwa*
  *Ekalanja achubwa Mikoni*
*Owa Mushekya-ngabo na Kilwana owa Kikabuzi ka Nyamwanja*
"'Waitu omuti Mafumbo
Kihanja gwakubaijwa iwe
Waitu obwato bwa enyanja
Waitu engahi myenda ebili
Kandi obwwa Ngono Kishala
Nabwo mishomelo myenda ebili
Bagubaije eibetelezo
Kihanja bwakwalikilwa iwe
Bagubaije engoma ejuge
Kihanja gwakugya na Bujumba'"

PLOT OUTLINE

**Lines 45-60:**
The men return to the king and report, and the king summons artisans and sends them off to cut down the tree.

**Lines 61-63:**
[The men travel and arrive at dusk.] They make their sacrifice (lines 61-1.1). At dawn they find the sacrifices gone — taken by the spirit.

**Lines 64-86:**
The men try to cut the tree, but it refuses to be cut and speaks to them in a blaming and taunting way.

NOTES

52 *Kikuli* is a spirit whose shrine and medium was apparently on Bumbiile Island.

61.3 Mubilizi, mulinzi, and raffia are used to accompany sacrifices. Here, everything placed as sacrifices was gone in the morning.

They came and they hit the *Proclaimed one* of Ibale with this news.
They said, "The tree spreads out in all directions."
He answered, "Send to the ironsmiths of Kihanja."
They hurried and sent for Bikonya.
They sent for Lwabitwaga.
To Itongo village they hurried and sent for Kalugila.
They sent for Lukonwa.
They sent for Kagote.
The carpenters–I'll not deceive you–
They sent for Kahimbile, child of Lukola.
They-have-a-reason they took from Kagabilo village.
[He took some butter made from new-milk of a heifer cow,]

"Adze out for me," he said, "a lake canoe–
On Bumbiile Island I would greet Kikuli.
Adze out for me a beer vat–
I would ferment mash for Kihanja and Bujumba.
Adze out for me a roaring drum–
I would make them hear in Lukala and Bujumba.
Go adze out for me some vessels,
A milk pot to display at the hearth
A ladle that does not split.
Adze out for me a bow, the *Noble curve*."

Butter from the new-milk of a heifer they laid beside the tree,
And their axes, too.
When night gave way to dawn's early light,
Of axes they saw no *mubilizi* herb,
Of butter they saw no *mulinzi* wrapper,
Of cowries they saw no raffia strings.

Laughing until it nearly split his sides,
And rushing at the tree with an axe held high,
Kashega of Itongo drove iron into wood.
Said the tree, "You man, you've stung me.
You've stung me all over.
You've not left a part.
Inside are *lugondo* serpents,
Others that snatch the heart away
And serpents that are white.
You've stung me.
You've spat on me all over.
But what is my blame? Why make my body tremble?

Baija Bagamuteza Ndagwa ya Ibale

Ati omuti waitu gwayahya gwona
Ahi ntumila abahesi Kihanja
Bailuka batuma Bikonya
Batuma Lwabitwaga
Itongo bailuka batuma Kalugila
Batuma Lukomwa
Batuma Kagote
Ababaizi ntakulembale
Batuma Kahimbile owa Lukola
Bantuleisha bamwiya Kagabilo.

[Yagila amajuta g'eilola limo g'ente y'ensigaijo]

Mumbaizile obwato bw'enyanja
Bumbile nakulamya Kikuli
Mumbaizile obw'amalwa
Ninyija kwalikila Kihanja n'obujumba
Mumbaizile engoma kakuunga
Nakuhuliliza Lukala na Bujumba
Mugende mumbaizile enteeko
Ekyanzi ky'omugamba
Endosho etashangaile
Mubaizilemu obuta Nyakakondo

Majuta g'eilola limo g'ente y'ensigaizibagya babilaza amuti ogwo
N'endyamiti zabo
Kobwile bwasingile bukyakya
Endyamiti tibaboine mubilizi
Amajuta tibaboine kilinzi
Ensimbi tibabione lushongolwa

Yasheka zamwata
Kayahalaile n'endyamiti emo
Kashega Itongo yagujugunyila
Guti "Iwe mushaija wanduma
Wanduma nyena
Tolansigila lugingo
Omunda alimu eza Lugondo
Enjoka ezindi ni Kashakula-mwoyo
Alimu enjoka zilikwela
Wanduma
Wanchwela gona
Wantula(ki)? (wa)njalagaza lugingo?

PLOT OUTLINE

**Lines 88-134.2:**
When the men report to the king, he orders divination to find a way to cut down the tree; he orders gifts for Mugasha to secure his help.

NOTES

84.1 The tree issues its call of defiance: The tree's antagonist may be able to stir what can't (even) be sliced: that is, he may be able to stir porridge so thick and hard that it can't even be divided into portions. But, the tree declares, the antagonist's heretofore irresistible force has met an immovable object. The tree proclaims this defiance twice - first to Rugomora (line 84.1) and then to Mugasha (line 299). As the voice of Wamara, the tree articulates opposition between the "ancient" religion of the Bachwezi spirits and the more recent royal state embodied in King Rugomora. Mugasha, the voice of non-pastoral peasants, allies himself with the kingship.

85 Kyandekwe Kahinda, Kakayange, and Kabogoiga are personal names. The tree boasts defiantly that it has been a wicked influence in Mahe's kingdom.

90 *Divining* to see what will kill (the tree) is a special kind of divination, *oku-chweleza*. The more usual divination is *oku-lagula*.

Go tell the king, the *Proclaimed one*:
'Let them adze you into a lake canoe'?
I won't go on my back!
'Let them adze you into a fermentation vat'?
I won't be warmed by fire!
'Let them adze you into a zither. Sing out like this one'?
I won't be pulled with strings!
'A drum–cry out for many'?
I won't be knocked about by sticks!
'Let them adze you into a fermentation vat'?
I won't be warmed by fire!
'A mash-press vat–press mash among royal followers'?
I won't be kneaded by fists!

Go tell the King, Lugomola of Ibale,
'In Kihanja you may be *He who stirs what can't be sliced*.
But in Mafumbo you have been stopped by Mwata.
This tree made Kyandekwe Kahinda be bad.
It entered the rivers of Bushagala Itongo.
In Kafunjo it makes Kakayange be bad.
In Ilogelo it makes Kabogoiga be bad.'"
It said, "In upper Kihanja, stop your carving."

[He said, "Consult diviners. Let us find out."]
When they told the *Bast that keeps* enkuku *beans from insect blight*,
*Little palm, cut from Mikoni.*
*From Makes-shields-laugh and Fighter of Kikabuzi and Nyamwanja.*
He said, "Consult diviners. Let us see what kills the axe-defying tree."

They divined four days.
On the fifth came their report:
"The tree will come in four years' time to topple you, Lugomola."

He said, "What shall I do, Bahamba of Lweju of Mushendwa,
*Arrows that never lick the earth,*
*Kafumu of Mugunje,*
*All you children of Imalila*?
What can I send to kill this tree?"
The King of [. . . ]
He said, "Shall I send to . . ."
One said, "Send word of it to Mugasha of Isheshe."

Ogye ogile Omukama *Ndangwa*
'Bakubaije obwato bw'enyanja'?
Tinakugenza mugongo!
'Bakubaije eibetelezo'?
Tinakyehembelwa mulilo!
'Bakubaije enanga ojuge nkegi?'
Tinakunyululwa miguha!
'Engoma ojuge omubangi'?
Tindikomwakomwa miziyo!
Bakubaije obweibetelezo
Tindihembwa mumulilo
Eijungilo ojunge omumbaga
Tiinakunyukililwa bitome

Mugye mugile omukama Lugomola lwa Ibale
Muti 'Kihanja oba *Nyamugoya obutangwa*
Mafumbo wayangwa Mwata.
Gwafakaza Kyandekwe Kahunda
Gwataha emiga ya Bushagala Itongo Kafunjo
Gwafakaza Kakayange Ilogelo
Gwafakaza Kabogoiga
Guhi, "Kihanja eigulu mulekeile kubaija."

[Ahi Chweleza tumanye]
Olwo bamugambile *Byai akoma enkuku iyabungwa*

*Ekalanja achubwa Mikoni*
*Owa Mushekya-ngabo na Kilwana owa Kikabuzi na Nyamwanja*
Ahi, "Chweleza tulebeayangile kugwelela mbaizi."

Bachweleza ebilo bina
Ekyakatanu ekaija eli balulo:
"Omuti gwasiga ebyanda bina kutema naiwe Lugomola"

Ahi, "Ngilenta Bahamba ba Lweju lwa Mushendwa

*Mihambi etalamba itaka*
*Kafumu ka Mugunje*
*Inywe bana ba Imalila*
Omuti ngutumileki?"
Omukama Kyakilanya
Ahi ngutumile omwa . .
Ohi waitu ogutumile omwa Mugasha Isheshe

NOTES

102 Entembe are coffee-bean-size seeds that grow in the fruit of a wild banana plant. They are associated with Mugasha. Coffee berries cooked by boiling are a delicacy and mild stimulant frequently offered as hospitality to guests.

104 *Mugasha's hidden maiden*, like his serving girl on line 99.1, is a reference to Lyanyaibungo, the god-king Wamara's daughter.

106 These images of oddity and reversal characterize the supernatural strangeness of the land to which they will travel.

When they said this to the *Proclaimed one*,
The King said "Run to Wamala
*Essential killer*,
*Bows and bends*,
*Supple one of Ndahula*,
*Papyrus stands rock up and down*.
His son is Kagolo
*Babbler-wobbler*,
*Decorated all over*,
*Corners of Lutungi village of Kamanzi*.
*They cut it in Nongo forest–it fell in Kalushekya*.
*Honey in the rock cannot easily be drawn*.
*He killed a man in Kihanja–He boasted among his affines in Kiziba*.
*He went and he withdrew from Sesse*
*The hidden serving girl of Mugasha*
*With his copper spear*.

He said "Hurry, hurry, hurry, hurry, hurry.
Go to the Stauncher's place
Bring eight *entembe* seeds.
Those are the coffee berries of Mugasha
And of Mugasha's hidden maiden."

He said, "Goto Lweya and Lwazi,
*Where they churn but do not rub themselves with butterfat*,
*They've become accustomed to the rain, and warm themselves by moonlight as by sun*,
*A child never opens the door for them at sunrise–*
*Bringing firewood she finds them as awake at dawn as at sunset*.
*Where a woman grinds millet with her husband hoisted on her back*.
*Where a dog yearns for the shaving knife*

Those who traveled down inside the canoe were eight.
The helmsman was the ninth.
Rugomora said, "Go to Ihangiro to Kishashwe's place.
Go and get a virgin pot that has never cracked
Or even cooked a person's plantains.

Olwo bamugambile Ndangwa
Ahi Mwiluke mugende omwa Wamala
*Lwa Nyakwisa*
*Olukwinamile*
*Oluyonga lwa Ndaula*
*Mbimbili itengatenga*
Omutabani Kagolo
*Buchecheba*
*Buhunzile bwona*
*Nshenda za Lutenge Kamanzi*
*Babutema Nongo -- Bwagwela Kalushekya*
*Bwoki bweibale -- Tahakulwa mpango --*
*Omuntu yamwita Kihanja -- yamwetonda amaihwa Kiziba*
*Agya (baibwa) amwihya Nsheshe*
*Omuzana nsholeke ya Mugasha*
*Neichumu ly'omulinga*

Ahi, "Iluka iluka iluka iluka iluka
Mugende omwa Gahimbila
Mulete entembe munana
Ako kamwani ka Mugasha
N'omwisiki nsholeke ya Mugasha"

Ahi mugende Luyeya na Lwazi
*Bachunda tibesiga*

*Balamanyile enjula yabo. Bota omwezi nk'omushana*

*Tibakingulilwa lwigi omwana*
*Bukya nabubona bwaigolo n'olukwi n'otushanju*

*Mbali omukazi asa ahekile iba*

*(?)[Mbali embwa egondeza olumwoiso]*

Abagendamu ey'omunana
Omugoba w'obwato muntu w'omwenda
Ahi, "Mugende Ihangilo omwa Kishashwe
Mugye mwihyemu enyungu y'omwalietakashangaile
Etakachumbilaga muntu bitoke

NOTES

112.1 Nyakalembe, Mugasha's wife, is the spirit associated with women's agricultural work. Kabagala is a kind of hoe they use in this work.

116 These are the bard's version of epithets for the spirit Bwogi.

121-123.1 These are the bard's version of epithets for the spirit Kazoba, the sun

125 The *eight loving ones* refers to the Bachwezi, a pantheon of possessing spirits. As in the ballad Kajango, the mortals first consult a succession of spirit mediums, and then meet face-to-face with a spirit who then becomes a protagonist in the narrative.

He said, "Go to Stauncher's place.
Have him adze me a ladle that will not split,
Of Mother Nyakalembe *of Kabambagwa and Nyamwema*,
*Iron ruled by Kabagala*,
*Which bent itself to cultivate*,
*Of Mukashuga and Galengaine in Kihanja of Malagwe and Manunga*.

He said "Hurry to the copper spear."
He said "Go and take it from the place of Bwogi, the *Separator*
*The Muzinza says it angrily at Kimbugu among the Basingo clan*.
*He killed a man with a big penis*.
*I found women's vaginas mourning*,
*"He's killed the Testicle-shaker."*
*No one ate from the kitchen pots–*
*A terrible thing–the pots lay empty, rocking back and forth*.
*In Kimbugu he came from among the Basingo*.

He said, "Run and ask Sun,
*Great branches of Luhuga*,
*Child of others*.
*They make no sound, of Luyenje*.
*Raised, imploring arms he favors*,
*Among the elders he speaks first*.

When he had finished with all of them–
The eight loving ones–
He said "Take these matters to Mugasha,
*Water dweller, Wide strider, with* ntembe *seeds*.
[Say], 'Conquer, provider,
Please give the King your axe,
*Cleaver of* mugege *wood*,
*Splitter of dried* mukoni *trees*,
So he may go and cut Muhata with it.'"

He said, "Sacrifice at Bwigula to the Catcher and the Preceeder of cold,
The Ever-satisfied one of Bwigula village.
May Lukebela be victorious.
And may he give us his canoe *Kingdom-size*
And the second, *Compassion*.

Ati, "Mugende omwa Gahimbila
Agende ambaizile endosho etashangaile
Eya mawe Nyakalembe lya *Kabambagwa na Nyamwema*
*Obwoma butwalwa Kabagala*
*Akabandamila kulima*
*Ka Mukashuga na Galengaine Kihanja Malagwe na Manunga*

Ahi Mwiluke Eichumu ly'omulinga
Ahi, "Mugye muliye omwa Bwogi *Ngungi*

*Muzinja agamba etoboka Kimbugu kya Busingo*

*Akaita ow'embolo mpango*
*Abakazi nashanga zatela ekibobo*
*Akaita Luchunda-magosi*
*Tibabilile enyungu omumwanya*
*Kizila zikalala kayogolekano*
*Kimbugu atemwa Busingo*

Ati Mwiluke mubaze *Kazoba*
*Bishonga bya Luhuga(?)*
*Muto w'abandi*
*Bitalahe ebya Luyenje*
*Mutegelwa biganjaakabyama*
*Omubakulu yagamba mbele*

Olwo yasigile yamalila abo bona,
Abakwenda munana,
Ahi, "Mbitwalile Mugasha
*Lwa Kyomumaizi*, *Lwagaga*, *n'entembe*
[Oti] 'Osinge Lugaba
Omuhe akalyamiti akawe
*Lwasa Migege*
*Lugangabula emikoni ekoma*
Agye kutemesa Muhata.'"

Ahi, "Mugye mugabile Bwigula Lukwata na Lwebembela Milombe
Kaikala Kaigusile ka Bwigula
Lukebela asinge
Atuhe obwato Kikila bukama
Obwa kabili Kashasila mwoyo

PLOT OUTLINE

**Lines 135-149.4:**
The men paddle on the lake and make sacrifices to spirits.

**Lines 150-60:**
The king's emissaries go on foot to the home of Thunderstorm, where they receive directions to Mugasha.

NOTES

140-147 These lines are quoted from women's wedding songs. Paddlers use them here to synchronize their effort.

152 The gray fowl is the thunderbolt bird that when hurled by Thunderstorm causes destruction on earth.

They paddled.

And when they arrived,
They brought the tribute to the spirit-medium Lukebela.
They sacrificed to Catcher.
They sacrificed to Preceeder of cold,
The Ever-satisfied one of Bwigula village.
When night gave way to the early light of dawn,
He gave them the canoe *Kingdom-size*
And the second, *Compassion*.
I heard the paddles cry out in unison

And when they had sailed out on Lake Victoria,
They sang, "*If it's dead, toss it.*
*The rotten one has none to bury it*."

*They saw a bellowing cow.*
*'Mother,' it said, 'mother,*
*May what is purchased fall in the water.'*

*When the grasshopper was to travel,*
*His father sacrificed to the lake wind Ndahula*."

They paddled and reached Bumbiile.
They sacrificed to Kikuli.
They sacrificed to Kisho.
They sacrificed to Nyabusana and to Nyabuyonga.
They took the lake toward Binengo.
They went to Bugoziba.
They went to Bukwaya and Kinagi
They went to Musalala and Lumondo Islands,

My lord, from there they went on foot.
They traveled and they rested at the home of
Thunderstorm in Katakubwa.
They met Thunderstorm,
*Drinks not beer,*
*Essential warrior.*
A gray fowl in his fingers.

Babuga

Olwo bazile
Byona ebihongo babileta omwa Lukebela
Bagabila Lukwata
Bagabila Lwebembela Milombe
Kaikala kaigusi(le) ka Bwigula
Olw' obwile bwasingile bukyakya
Yabaha obwato Kikila bukama
Obwa kabili Kashasila mwoyo
Mpulila engahi netokela

Olwo basabaile Lwelu
Ziti, "*Kyafa naga*
*Nkyatukuma nkyabulwa abaziki.*

*Ngu lyabona ente nebologa*
*Eti, 'Mae,' eti, 'mae,*
*Kobugule kagw' omumaizi.'*

*Olw' emoma yagya kugenda*
*Ishe akaba agabile Oluhunga lwa Ndaula omunyanja*."

Babuga baija Bumbile.
Bagabila Kikuli.
Bagabila Kisho.
Bagabila Nyabusana Nyabuyonga.
Enyanja bakwata aga Bunengo
Bagya Bugoziba.
Bagya bagya Bukwaya Kinagi
Bagya Musalala na Lumondo

Waitu amagulu agabahile aho
Bagya balala omwa Nkuba Katakubwa

Bashanga Nkuba
*Tanywa Malwa*
*Ka Nyalumanzi.*
Enkoko y'olujumba omubyala.

PLOT OUTLINE

**Lines 161-179:**
They journey on the lake, find the fisher-god at the lakeshore, and present their gifts; he is much amused.

NOTES

165 These epithets refer to Mugasha.

171 *Bitoma* is a village in Kihanja associated with the spirit-king Wamara and named for large Mutoma trees. These trees are frequently shrines or places of sacrifice to Wamara. In the early 20th century, Hermann Rehse recorded a belief that at death the soul of an "ordinary man" in the northern Haya kingdom of Kiziba goes to Bitoma village, where a priest of the spirit of Wamala lives.

171.1-171.2 These epithets for Wamara refer to the stereotypic lanky body and loose gait of royalty.

"Long life to the Fearless one, Father of men!
This greeting is not ours. It is that of [Rugomora.]"
He answered, "Dawn came in peace."
They replied, "But peace is absent.
We must go to Mugasha, *Water dweller*,
We'll go to Mugasha, *Water dweller*,
*Whose touch kills*,
*Whose mediation pacifies*,
*Of planting and earthquakes*,
*Father of Rain, the Cloudburst*,
*Urine that is drunk*,
*Causes crops to grow in dense profusion*,
*Hurler of Destruction*,
*Unraveler of sheep herds*,
*Banana plants that cultivate themselves*,
*King with the little feet of a* kafunzi *bird*."
He said "Now that you've come to Kyashalashala,
Paddle night and day: from Kyashalashala
Pour yourselves on to Sesse of Katanda, Mugasha's home.
You will meet *Drinks not beer*.
My lord, *Drinks not sweet banana pulp*."

We paddled night and day.

weye weye
They paddled night and day.

From Kyashalashala they poured themselves on to Sesse of Katanda,
The *Catcher* and the *Hardened one*.
They found *Drinks not beer*, *Drinks not sweet banana pulp*.
He was doing a winnowing dance on the beach at Kilembeka.
They kneel and salute.

"Long life to the Fearless one, Father of men!
This greeting is not mine. It is that of King Rugomora.
Long life to the Fearless one, Father of men!
This greeting is not mine. It is that of the *Writer*.

My lord, Rugomora's royal stool
He took from the home of Wamala in Bitoma,
*Supple-one of Ndahula*.
*The reedy swamp rocks up and down*.

"Enshongole malama, Ishe abashaija!"
Ati, "Ti kyange kya (Mugasha)."
Ahi, "Bwakya milembe"
Ahi, "Kyonka emilembe teliyo.
Tugye omwa lwo Mugasha lwa *Ky'omumaizi*,
Tulagya omwa lwo Mugasha *lwa Ky'omumaizi*,
*Lukolela okwita*,
*Lutonganisa kulamula*
*Owo buhamba n'obujugumo*
*Ish' enjula nagwa*
*Nkali enyobwa*
*Luhingika bihambo*
*Mutete [mujugunyo] gwa lwita mahanga*
*Muzingulula ntama*
*Babyelimile koko ya ngemu*
*Omukama bugulu bwa kafunzi*
Ati, "Anunju mwijao Kyashalashala
Mubuge ekilo n'omushana Kyashalashala
Musheshe Isheshe lya katanda omwa Mugasha

Mwashanga *Tanwa-malwa*.
Waitu takanywaga na mulamba."

Twabuga ekilo n'omushana

weye weye
Babuga ekilo n'omushana

Kyashalashala bashesha Lya Katanda

*Omubaka na Igumilo*
Bashanga *Tanywa-malwa*, *Tanywa-mulamba*
Akaba naitila engoma y'enchencha amumwalo gwa Kilembeka
Babandama balamya.

"Enshongole malama, Ishe abashaija!
Tikyange kya Lugomola
Enshongole malama, Ishe abashaija!
Tikyange kya mpandiki

Waitu Lugomola yagila entebe ey'entaita
Yagiya omwa Wamala Bitoma
*Olukwinamile oluyongo lwa Ndaula*
*Mbimbili itengatenga*

PLOT OUTLINE

**Lines 180-91:**
Mugasha's wife Nyakalembe appears and Mugasha explains to her the identity of the men and their mission (lines 180-84). Mugasha and Nyakalembe feed the men.

**Lines 192-208.2:**
Mugasha summons his nature-spirit minions.

NOTES

172 The hidden serving girl of Mugasha refers to Lyanyaibungo, the god-king Wamara's daughter, whose courtship by the fisher god is the subject of the ballad Mugasha. Here she is called a domestic slave, *omuzana*, perhaps to emphasize that she was unwillingly wed -- and then bravely rescued by her brother Kagoro. On line 104, she is referred to as a maiden, *omwisiki* , perhaps to emphasize her youth and beauty.

187 *Make the plantains flee*, that is, cause them to be eaten with relish.

Kagolo, *the Babbler-wobbler*, is his son,
*Decorated all over*,
*Corners of Lutungi village of Kamanzi*,
*From Sesse he took Mugasha's hidden serving girl*."
Mugasha's laughter almost split his sides.

The pot that never for a person cooked–they brought it out for Mother Nyakalembe
of Kabambagwa and Nyamwema
The white knife that comes from Mwizi's in Itongo.
His laughter almost split his sides.

My lord, provider,
*Entembe* seeds are Mugasha's coffee berries.
His laughter almost split his sides.

While men were making their report,
She emerged, wife Nyakalembe,
Of Kabambagwa and Nyamwema,
*Iron ruled by Kabagala*.

"Where do all these men come from?" she asked.
"They're traveling about," he said.
"They come from Kyamutwara,
Messengers of Rugomora.
They came to borrow *Kicks-over-trees*, my axe.
I hear they have a tree they call Muhata.
Give these men gifts.
Let's not bring shame to ourselves or to our Sesse Island."

He took a Lake Victoria fish trap
And caught some little fish.
We call them *otuyamba* in Kihanja.
–Now they're the ones that make the plantains flee–
They were the coffee berries he offered them.
They ate four days but did not finish the basket.
He cut the plantain *falls-to-earth-still-green*–the *kyolele* type.
They ate four days but did not finish the stalk.
The cassava was *ekikulu* medicine root;
They never finished it.

He called Butterfly,
*Man without strength*,
Mugasha's favorite at Sesse.

Omutabani Kagolo *buchecheba*
*Buhunzile bwona*
*Nshenda za Lutungi Kamanzi*
*Yagila bwansheshe omuzana nsholeke yawe Mugasha*.
Yasheka zamwata

Enyungu etakachumbilaga muntu ya mawe Nyakalembe
lya Kabambagwa na Nyamwema
Omuhyo gulikwela gwaluga omwa Mwizi Itongo
Yasheka zamwata

Waitu lugaba
Entembe niko kamwani ka Mugasha Isheshe
Yasheka zamwata

Kabashaija babaile mbabalula,
Yatuluka omukaziwe Nyakalembe,
Lya Kabambagwa na Nyamwema,
*Bwoma butwalwa Kaba(n)gala*

"Abashaija aba bona baluga nkaha?"
Ati, "Bazongola
Baluga Kyamutwala
Ntumwa za Lugomola
Baizile kutiza endyamiti *y'Olusinjo*
Nahulila omuti eibala bagwisa Muhata
Tangilila abashaija
Tutagoka tutakugokela Isheshe

Yatwala omugono Lwelu
Yabaitila otufulu otutituti otwo
Kihanja tweta otuyamba.
-Mbwenu niwe ibilingisa bitoke-
Nzo mwani zabatangilile
Balyaho ebilo bina tibazimazile muntukulu
Ekitoke yabatemela *eky' Enyabwehogole* mpambo ya kyoilele
Balyaho ebilo binatibakimazil' amugogo
Ekigando yabaila ekikulu
Tibakimazile kahi(?)

Yamweta Kayoiyo
Omushaija, omushaija ataina mani
Niyo nganzi ya Mugasha Isheshe

PLOT OUTLINE

**Lines 209-230.1:**
One by one, the lake-related spirits attend and are praised.

NOTES

195 Leg over , from *Oku-kilambuza*, which means literally to pass one's leg and foot over something, like a rock (to avoid tripping on it). Among children, I was told, passing a leg over someone's head is a way to start a fight.

He said "Call my man Leg-over.
Let him go outside and beat my drum
They-die-but-they've-been-told.
He went outside and called him.
He said, "Leg-over,
Take out Mugasha's drum and beat
They-die-but-they've-been-told."
Beaten with a single drumstick, it roared out from the drumming place.
It went to Sina,
It went to Ibanda,
It went to Bunyonya villages,
It went to Bugonzi Babukooya Island,
To Musalala and Lumonda Islands.
iyoo
To Kinagiha Ilamba village,
To Bumbiile Island of Mukwi,
And Kiyagazi village on Nyabulo Island.

What was borne on water
Travelled along, then stood up tall at Mazinga.
What was borne by way of our own Kyamutwara
Passed through Karagwe
And called together people even in Rwanda.
What was borne in the direction to his left–
Bugabo of Kateite and Buganda–
Travelled along, then stood up tall in Bunyoro.

The nature-spirit that attended first was Overcast.
The nature-spirit that attended Sesse first was Overcast.
Mugasha said, "Sit a bit. I haven't yet inquired what I need to know."

While we were there,
Rain attended,
*The Cloudburst*,
*Urine that is drunk*,
*Causes crops to grow in dense profusion*,
*Hurler of destruction*,
*Legs hold rain and ripe bananas*,
*Hips accompany sweet banana mash.*
My friend, *of the potters whose skill is not to shape a pot and fire itat once.*
He said "Sit a bit. I havn't sent anyone yet."

Ahi nyetela omushaija wange Kilambuza
Atuluke agitele engoma yange Bafa bagambilwe

Yatuluka yamweta
Ahi, "Kilambuzi
Tulukya engoma yange ogitele Bafa bagambilwe

Yasinda omuziyo gumo alubungo

Gwagya Sina
Gwagya Ibanda
Gwagya Bunyonya
Gwagya Bugonzi Babukooya
Musalala na Lumonda
iyoo
Kinagi na Ilamba
Bumbile bwa Mukwi
Gwe Kiyagozi Nyabulo

Ogwatwetwe omumaizi
Gwagya gwainugukila Mazinga
Ogwatwetwe Kyamutwala yaitu
Kalagwe gwagigutujanyia
Gwahuluza na Lwanda
Ogwatwetwe omukono gwa bumosho
Bugabo Kateite Buganda
Gwagya gwaginuguka Bunyolo

Omulanzi yahulwile mbele ni Kile
Omulanzi yahulwile Isheshe mbele ni Kile
Ahi, "Shangwa oliyo tinkabalize kumanyage.

Katwabaile tuliho
Yahulula Njula
*Lwanago*
*Nkali enyobwa*
*Luhingika bihambo*
*Mutete mujugunyo gwa lwita mahanga*
*Magulu galimu enjula n'ebihiise*
*Enygunyu ikwatilaine n'omulamba*
Baba *owababumbi bubya atali ababumbila kwikya*

Ahi, "Shangwa oliyo tinkalagize."

PLOT OUTLINE

**Lines 231-51:**
Then one by one they vow great achievement in the battle to come.

NOTES

219 *Nsenene* is a grasshopper that swarms once a year and is cooked and eaten with great relish.

232 Mugasha asks his minions to chant their praise (*okw-ebuga*) as warriors do before battle. This genre also appears in other ballads.

Sun attended,
*Great branches of Luhuga.*
*Child of others.*
*Ariser with the dawn.*
*Among elders he speaks first.*
He said, "Sit a bit. I haven't sent a spirit yet."

While we were there,
Night attended,
*Distant sound of women's wailing song,*
*Bringer of lions and leopards,*
*Darkness is his companion.*
He said, "Sit a bit. I haven't sent anyone yet."

Nsenene attended, *Big chest*
*[praise of nsenene not understood]*
He said, "Sit a bit. I haven't sent anyone yet."

While he was there in the forecourt [Interruption]
Thunderstorm attended, *Essential warrior.*
He attended, a gray fowl held between his fingers.
Thunderstorm attended, *Essential warrior.*
Thunderstorm attended, *Essential warrior.*
A gray fowl held between his fingers.

He struck between the gateposts of the forecourt.
Mugasha arose from his copper stool.
He said, "Thunderstorm, you're drunk!
If you kill the *Proclaimed one's* men,
Don't swing your feet around and report to me.
If you kill the *Proclaimed one's* cattle,
Don't you dare report to me."

Thunderstorm answered, "My lord, I go for the Mafumbo tree.
There's no ill will that takes me."

I heard him call them loyal ones.
"Chant your praise," he said. "Go off to war.
Overcast, you are the spirit who attended first."
*"I go to lie on the Mafumbo plot*
*The nights I stay there will be eight.*
*I'll cut what-cannot-be-turned-to-firewood by man."*
"Be off," he responded.
"For children it is a time of fevers.

Yahulula Kazoba
*Bishonga byalwoga(?),*
*Muto wa abandi,*
*Akalamukya mbele na lukyakya,*
*Omubakulu yagamba mbele.*
Ahi, "Shangwa oliyo. Tinkalagize mulanzi."

Katwabaile tuliho
Yahulula Kilo
*Kya Mpundu,*
*Ntwala Entale n'engo,*
*Kyonka omwilima gugenda nanye.*
Ahi, "Shangwa oliyo tinkalagize."

Yahulula Nsenene *Iwa kishenge*
*Kalimu obwengule enkulungo elimu amahyange*
Ahi, "Shangwa oliyo tinkalagize."

Kayabaile aliyo omwilembo[Interruption]
Yahulula Nkub*aka Nyalumanzi*
Yahulula enkoko y'olujumba omubyala
Yahulula Nkubaka Nyalumanzi
Yahulula Nkubaka Nyalumanzi
Enkoko y'olujumba omubyala

Katelela omubiti by'amalembo
Kainugukila omuntebe y'omulinga
Ahi, "Nkuba otamila!
Koliita omuntu wa *Ndangwa*
Oyalikuba bilenge kwija kubalula
Koliita ente ya *Ndangwa*
Otalija kubalulila nye."

"Waitu nagendela omuti gwa Mafumbo

Tinagenda bantwalile ndwano

Nkahulila yabeta abakwenda.
Ahi, "Yebuge otabale.
Iwe Kile niwe mulanzi wahulwile mbele."
*"Ngye ndale kibanja Mafumbo*
*Ebilo ndakeisa munana*
*Nteme tegulishenywa muntu."*
Ahi, "Iloko
Abana lwona gulaba mushwago.

Rain attended, the *Cloudburst*.
He said, "*My lord, I'll go and lie eight nights and eight days.*"
He said, "*I'll cut what-cannot-be-turned-to-firewood by man.*"
"Be off," he responded.
"In Kihanja, papyrus islands sweep down a swollen Ngono river."

Sun chanted his praise.
He said, "*The days I'll fall there will be eight,*
*And eight nights will I arise.*
*I'll cut the tree that-cannot-be-turned-to-firewood by man.*"
"Be off," he responded.
"Kihanja and Bujumba have a great, hot, drying sun."
shshshsh

Night chanted his praise,
*Distant sound of women's wailing song, Time for reclining.*
He said, "*My lord, The days I'll lie there will be eight.*"
He said, "*And eight nights will I arise.*
*I'll cut what-cannot-be-turned-to-firewood by man.*"
"Be off," he responded.
"Rugomora sends to know the meaning of such darkness."

Nsenene chanted his praise, *Big chest [praise not understood].*
He said, "*The days I go to cut the tree are eight*
*And eight nights will I spend.*
*The daytimes I fall from the sky will be eight.*
*I'll cut the tree that-cannot-be-turned-to-firewood by man.*"
"Be off," he said.
"In Kihanja they go out to gather with bushel baskets."

Yahulula Njula *Lwanango*.
Ahi, "*Waitu ngye ndale Mafumbo ebilo munana n'emishana munana*
Ahi, "*Nteme tigulishenywa muntu.*"

Ahi, "Iloko
Kihanja ebigangala byagya kugenda Ngono."

Yayebuga Kazoba
Ahi, "*Ndigwamu emishana munana*
*N'ebilo nkeise munana.*
*Nteme omuti tigulishenywa muntu.*"

Ahi, "Iloko
Kihanja na Bujumba lulaba Luhato."
shshshsh

Yayebuga Kilo
*Kyampundu na balaile*

Ahi, "*Waitu ndi(landa)lamu ni ebishana munana.*"
Ahi, "*N'ebilo ndikeise munana*
*Nteme tigulishenywa muntu.*"
Ahi, "Iloko.
Lugomola yagya kulaguza"

Yayebuga Nsenene, *Lwa Kishenge kalimu obwengula(?)*

Ati, "*Nagya kutema omuti ebilo munana.*
*N'ebilo ndamalamu munana.*
*N'emishana ngwe munana*
*Nteme omuti tigulishenywa muntu.*"

Ahi, "Iloko
Kihanja bagya kuhunga.

PLOT OUTLINE

**Lines 251.1-71:**

Mugasha provisions them and sets them on their journey (lines 251.1-259). They travel to the tree.

Thunderstorm chanted his praise, *Essential-warrior*.
"*My lord, the days will be covered over.*
*I'll close the sky with a single cloud*
*That begins at Sesse of Katanda*
*And stretches out to Karagwe of Nono.*
*Drizzling rain I'll add to the overcast.*
*They'll take the infants from the courtyard.*
*Whatever's spread to dry, they'll bring in, too.*
*I'll cut the tree that-cannot-be-turned-to-firewood by living being*."
"Be off," heanswered.
"Return with your reports."
His laughter almost split his sides.

A canoe he loaded made of a raffia palm.
A provision he packed for them of *ekikulu* root, *dog-washer*.
They said the provision he packed for them was cassava.
The plantain he cut for them was *falls-to-earth-still-green*–the *kyolele* type.
Sawdust,
My lord, he packed for them: it was their flour.

He tossed them in the boat.
At Kilembeka shore Mugasha pushed.
No nature spirit paddled.
He just stood at Sesse and pushed
And away it rocked across Lake Victoria.
The current that took them from Sesse of Katanda,
My lord, My lord, in Kihanja it pushed them down to Bwigula.
Sacrifices had already been made there
To the Catcher
And the Precursor of cold
And the Ever-satisfied one of Bwigula village.

What joy there was!
That day they climbed the mountain pass to Kilinzi.
In Fragrant-trees, my kings.
In Boundaries and Mayondwe,

They saw the tree in the direction of Buzinza.
It left Kihanja in Mafumbo
And appeared in the direction of Buzinza.

Yayebuga Nkuba ka Nyalumanzi.
"*Waitu emishana elishanga elibile.*
*Nkome oluchwi lumoi*
*Lweme Isheshe lya Katanda*
*Lutuluke Kalagwe ka Nono.*
*Ebijula bike ngu magamaganteho ekile.*
*Enkelemeke bazihye omukibuga*
*Aliba ayanikile abitahye*
*Nteme omuti tigulishenywa mulola."*

Ahi, "Iloko.
Mulija kubalulila nye.
Yasheka zamwata

Obwato yahika obw'omuhunge.
Entanda yabakomela eikulu kyogya embwa.

Ngu ntanda yabakomelela ekigando.

Ekitoke yabatemela enyabwehogola empambo ya kyolele

Ensano y'emiti,
Waitu niyo yakomile eli nsano.

Yabanaga omubwato.
Omwalo Kilembeka yasindika Mugasha.
Tibwabugilwe na mulanzi.
Akema Isheshe yasindika.
Bwalagala Lwelu.
Omushoke gwabahile Lwakatanda,
Waitu, waitu, Kihanja gwabasola Bwigula.

Bashanga agabile
Lukwata
na Lwebembela milombe
na Kaikala Kaigusile ka Bwigula.

Amashemelelwa gabaile aho!
Kilekyo empalo batembela Kilinzi.
Omuli Nyabugaju, bakama bange.
Omunyatanilo na Mayondwe

Baleba omuti gwagaluka Buzinja
Gwaluga Kihanja Mafumbo
Gwagaluka Buzinja.

PLOT OUTLINE

**Lines 272-86:**

Each of the nature spirits attacks the tree in its characteristic way, but the tree seems impervious.

They trod the road to Angrydog
–They were on the Kazindo road–
At Ntungamo they came to Mawela.
They climbed to Ishenge
They came to Katoke,
Kimbugu, and Nyamugunda.
At Ihangiro they crossed the gully at Muyenje.

Thunderstorm stood at Ukindi.
He went and showed himself at Lwazi.
He cut off the tree's route to Buzinja.
It came to Mafumbo of Kawe Kitabi and Mujunwa.

As you and I–they stood that close–
He sent . . .
Thunderstorm sent Overcast.
He said, "Begin. Cut down the tree, and let's go home.
You are the spirit who attended first at Sesse."

The days overcast hunched over the sky were eight,
And the nights he arose from were eight.
For children in Kihanja it was a time of fevers.
But it seemed forbidden that the tree would shed a single leaf.

The days Rain fell were eight,
And the nights he arose from were eight.
In Kihanja, my kings,
Papyrus islands swept down a swollen Ngono river.
But the tree seemed forbidden to shed a single leaf.

The days Sun's heat fell were eight,
And the nights it arose from were eight.
But it seemed forbidden that the tree would shed a single leaf.

The days the *Ensenene* fell were eight,
And the nights they arose from were eight.
Royal women had no *nkanga* baskets at all, at all.
My lord, in upper Kihanja they had to gather them in . . .
They gathered them in milk pots.
But it seemed forbidden that the tree would shed a single
iyayaya

Balibata omuhanda gwa Kaboyambwa,
-Mbaba bakwata omuhanda Kazindo-
Ntungamo baija Mawela.
Batemba Ishenge.
Baija Katoke
Kimbugu Nyamugunda.
Ihangilo bagutujanyia olusa lwa Muyenje

Nkuba yayema Ukindi.
Yagenda yazokela Lwazi.
Yagutanga Buzinja.
Gwaija Mafumbo ga Kawe Kitabi na Mujunwa

Nkaiwe nanye
Akatweka Kyeela
Akatweka Kiile
Ati, "Banza. Tema omuti. Tutahe
Niwe Mulanzi yahulwile mbele Isheshe"

Kile yabundala emishana munana,
N'ebilo akakeisa munana.
Kihanja abana gwaba mushwago.
Kizila tigwatongokile na kababi.

Enjula ekagwamu emishana munana.
N'ebilo ekakeisa munana
Kihanja, bakama bange,
Ebigangala Ngono bikagenda.
Kizila tigwatongokile na kababi.

Mushana akajwamu emishana munana.
N'ebilo akakeisa munana.
Kizila tigwatongokile na kababi.

Ensenene ikagwamu emishana munana.
N'ebilo zakeisa omunana.
Abahindakazi tibagila nkanga zona, zona.
Waitu Kihanja olugulu bakaihungila omu-
Baihungila omu byanzi
Kizila tigwatongokile na kababi

iyayaya

PLOT OUTLINE

**Lines 287-92:**
Finally, Thunder Storm attacks with rain and lightning bolts.

**Lines 293-300.2:**
The tree loses a single branch and calls out in pain and anger to the nature spirit. It sends a defiant message to Mugasha.

**Lines 301-14:**
Frustrated to tears, Thunder Storm brings the report to Mugasha.

NOTES

299 Tree's call of defiance: See note to line 84.1

*Essential-warrior* chanted his praise.
He closed in a cloud that began at Sesse of Katanda
And streched to Karagwe of Nono.
To Karagwe of Nono it stretched.
Drizzling rain fell:
Whatever had been put to dry they brought inside.
They took their infants in from the courtyard.
Then lightening flashed, struck the tree, and broke off single branch.

The tree called out again, "Thunderstorm,
*Essential-warrior*,
My lord, you've stung me. You've stung me all over.
You've not left a part.
Inside are *lugondo* serpents,
Others that snatch the heart away,
Little serpents of love.
In there are the serpents of Kamuyaya.
Spit the white on me.
The black brings leprosy.
You common flunky, don't pollute my body.

Go, speak to Mugasha, the *Water dweller* of Sesse.
Say, 'You may be *He who stirs what can't be sliced*.
But at Buzongola you've been thwarted by Muhata.
The tree defeated Rugomora,
And now it has defeated you.
It will not be adzed by a living being.'"

Anger seized Thunderstorm.
He didn't wait for the other nature spirits.
Borne aloft by a cloud,
He dropped down at Lyakatana,
Bawling tears in four, eight furrows on his face,
A sweet potato mound the ninth.

He hit him with the news, the *Water dweller*.
*Spraddle-legged, of* ntembe *seeds*,
*Planting, and earthquake*,
*Father of Rain, the Cloudburst*,
*Urine that is drunk*,
*Causes crops to grow in dense profusion*,
*Child of love.*
*Nyantende bore him,*
*Nyambubi molded him to shape.*
*He ended the barrenness of his father and mother.*
*Of the skilled potters, my lord, not those who shape and fire at once.*

Yayebuga *Kanyalumanzi*
Yakoma oluchwi lwayema Lwakatanda
Kalagwe lwatuluka ka Nono.
Lwatuluka Kalagwe Kanono.
Ebijula bike ngu magamaga,
Ayabaile ayanikile akataya.
Enkelemeke baziya omukibuga.
Kalabya kagutela kagwiyaho eishunju limo

Gwashuba gwakeeta guti, "Nkuba ka Nyalumanzi

Waitu, wanduma wanduma nyema
Tolansigila lugingo.
Omunda alimu eza Lugondo
Ezindi ni kashakula mwoyo
Obujoka bw'engonzi
Alimu obujoka bwa Kamuyaya
Onchwele agalikwela
Agalikwilagula gabembesa
Kilwilu otanjagalaza lugingo

Ogy'ogile Mugasha lwa *ky'Omumaizi* Isheshe
Oti, "Ngu oba *Nyamugoya obutangwa*
Buzongola bwayangwa Muhata
Gulemile Lugomola
Gwalema iwe
Tigulibaijwa mulola."

Nkuba enabi yamukwata.
Talalinzile balanzi.
Akatwalwa omuluchwi
Yalagala Lyakatana
Nalila binai munana
Eky'enkongolo kya mwenda

Yagamuteza *lwa Kyomumaizi*
*Lwagaga na Ntembe*
*Owa Buhamba n'obujugumo*
*Ishe njula, Lwanago*
*Nkali enyobwa.*
*Luhingika bihambo*
*Kyana ky'obwende*
*Nyantende yamuzala*
*Nyambubi yabumbabumba*
*Akamala ishe nanyina obugumba*
Owababumbi ba bubuya waituatali ababumbila kwokya

PLOT OUTLINE

**Lines 315-21.1:**
Mugasha makes preparations. He orders his drum to be sounded.

**Lines 322-48.2:**
Now other nature spirits arrive to aid him; each is duly praised and then transformed into a part of Mugasha's battle equipment.

He reported, "Lord, it says you may be *He who stirs what can't be cut*.
But at Buzongola you've been thwarted by Muhata.
The tree defeated Rugomora,
And now it has defeated you."

"Was it to me the tree proclaimed these words
Or was it to Rugomora?" Mugasha asked.
"My lord, it was to you the tree proclaimed these words."

He called Butterfly, Mugasha's favorite.
*Man without strength.*
He said, "Call Leg-over to me.
Have him go outside and beat my drum,
I go to war myself, *They-die-but-they've-been-told*..

Butterfly went out,
He called Leg-over.
He struck it with one stick, Leg-over.
The roar went to Sina.
It went to Ilamba.
It went to Binengo.
It went to Bugoziba.
It went to Bukwaya.
It went to Latakubwa Bashome and Lumondo.

Kinagi and Ilamba.

The roar that was borne by the lake toward Buganda
Rose up in Bunyoro.
The roar that went straightaway to our Kihanja
Through Karagwe it stepped to Rwanda.
The roar that was taken in the direction of the lake
Travelled along and rose up in Buzinja at the Mazinga islands.

One who attended that day . . .
As Mugasha stood there in the forecourt
He was surprised by Tortise,
*Can drums' roar harm me?*
There were two,
And they never made it past the vestibule.
One became sandals
The other, a helmet for Mugasha.

Ati, "Waitu ngu oba *nyamugoya obutanganwa*

Kihanja [Buzongola] bwayangwa Muhata
Gulemile Lugomola
Gwalema iwe."

Omuti gwabilagila nye
Angili gwabilagila Lugomola?
Waitu gwabilagilaiwe

Yamweta Kayoiyo, enganzi ya Mugasha.
*Omushaija ataina mani.*
Ahi Nyetela Kilambuzi
Atuluke agitele engoma yange.
Nyetabalile bafa bagambilwe.

Yatuluka Kayoiyo
Yayeta Kilambuzi
Yatela omuziyo gumo Kilambuzi
Gwagya Sina
Gwagya Ilamba
Gwagya Binengo
Gwagya Bugoziba
Gwagya Bukwaya
Gwagya Latakubwa Banshome (Maisome) na Lumondo (Lubondo)
Kinagi na Ilamba

Ogwatwetwe nyanja mukono ogu Buganda
Gwanugukila Bunyolo
Ogwagutujainyia Kihanja kyaitu
Kalagwe gwagilibata Lwanda
Ogwatwetwe omukono gw'enyanja
Gwagya gwagituluka Buzinja Mazinga

Ayahulwile kilekyo . . .
Kayabaile ailho omwilembo
Ayechula Akaisheikogoto
*Ebyengoma ijugaha*
Buli bubili
Tibawahingwile Nyalushasi
Akamo byaba bilatwa
Akasigaileho sheipa ya Mugasha

NOTES

345 Americans were reported to have walked on the moon on July 20, 1969. Muzee performed Mwata a month later, and I don't think he yet believed the news reports.

Hippopotami attended,
*Of the snuff infusion, One roar kills, [rest of praise not understood]*
Mugasha said, "If you would go with me to war.
Lie on your backs here on my land.
Let them flay you, let them take your hides to wear.
They agreed, and they lay on their backs.
They flayed them, and they set their hides to dry
Out in the little sun –- not over hot, like water coming to a boil.
They scraped the dried hides.
They sewed them.
He took the two hippopotami,
The first he tied over his shoulder as a cloak,
The second he took for his leather kilt.

Rainbow attended, *the Pouncer*.
When he came into the forecourt
He did not make it past the vestibule.
Mugasha said, "*Tall-fire*, you come from my own belly.
Now I'll tie you for a belt around my waist.
I won't leave you behind when I go to war.

Crocodile attended.
When Mugasha saw it, he said, "You Ngogo River croc,"
He said, "Come here. Let's go to war together.
In my hands, you'll be a dagger in its sheath.

Moon attended.
–You know, when she's above, she shows the way to all the retinue.
And the American tried a raid on her but failed.
Perhaps Mugasha can bring her down.

shushushu
He said, "Come, show your beauty.
I'll put handles on you there and there,"
He said, "You'll go under my arm. You'll be a shoulder bag.
You are the afterbirth in which I came, my kings.
Under my arm you'll go, a shoulder bag.

Yahulula Njubu
*Lwakilangi muku naita ebilemile Lusheke mbel' enyanja okwo enjala niyo ekushagaile*
Ahi, "Kamulaba nimutabala nanye
Mugalame Nyalubanja.
Bababage nywena, mbaiyeho empu z'okujwala
Zakunda zagalama
Baibaga bazita
Akashana katikati kekishalashala

Zayoma baisisima
Baitelana
Yakwata enjubu ibili
Yaibeba omumabega
Kandi eibili yakwata niho ngutu yayeho-

Yahulula Muhangazima Lwakibwita
Kagwaizile Nyalulembo
Tigwahingwile Nyalushasi
Ati, *"Lulilo* okaluga alabunda lwange
Mbwenu mukandala ngende nkwekomile enda
Tinakusiga iwe nkatabala

Yahulula Nshambi
Olwo yamazile kugibona,ati, "Iwe Nshambi ya Ngogo."
Ati, "Olugeyo, tutabale.
Omubyala wagenda oli mbanda."

Yahulula Kwezi
Niwe owo olikubona nabonesa embaga yona ali aigulu

N'Omumerika amutabalile byayanga
Shana yakuhanantulwa Mugasha

shushushu
Ati, "Oizile shemelelaha.
Nkutemu ebikaani noku noku."
Ati, "Ogende omule nyakwawa oli mfulebe
Niwe kinyina kyonaizilemu bakama bange
Omunyakwawa wagenda oli mfulebe."

PLOT OUTLINE

**Lines 349-355.1:**
Rain attends borne by three different winds and vows to accompany the fisher god.

**Lines 356-68:**
Mugasha asks his wife Nyakalembe to provision the trip and she does so.

**Lines 370-89:**
Nyakalembe decides she will also go to war and chants her praise as a warrior, which turns out to be women's wedding songs.

While he was there, the *Cloudburst*,
While he was there, the *Germinator of crops*
The *enshungu* wind he took from Bugabo
The *enkomaizi* wind from Buzinja.
The *omuyanja* wind of Machunda's home. . .
*[Praise of Machunda, king of Ukerewe, not understood]*
Rain said, "I attend. I've come to go to war."
He said,"I'll go to war with you.
I agree on what's to be hollowed out."

While he stood there in the forecourt,
Out came Nyakalembe.
He said, "My wife, are you still here?
Hurry to Katakubwa village.
Go and gather 'rock hair' plants for me.
Go with my serving girls.
Wrap it for me. It's my tobacco.
Wrap packets nine-times-two for me."

Off she hurried, Nyakalembe,
*Of Kabambagwa and Nyamwema,*
*Iron ruled by Kabagala.*
With serving maidens she went to Katakubwa village among the hills.
She gathered "rock hair" there.
She wrapped tobacco packets nine-times-two.

When Nyakalembe finished bringing them,
I saw: She cut a plantain for the guests: a *falls-to-earth-still-green* –- the *kyolele* type.
I saw: She wrapped *eikulu* root for cassava
I saw: Tiny *bukanda* fish she caught, eight fish traps worth.

shushushu
She was confounded Nyakulembe
*Of Kabambagwa and Nyamwena.*
She said, "My husband has become the *Fighter* . . ."

She said, "When he wants to go to war,
I see he packs everything into the moon!"
She said,"My husband!"
She said, "Let me chant my praise and go to war."
"Don't go!"

Kayabaile aliho *Lwanago*
Kayabaile aliho *Luhingika bihambo*
Enshungu yaiya Bugabo
Enkomaizi Buzinja
Omuyanja wa kakahuka omwa machunda
Gatelelaine ga Nyamutende
Ahi, "Nahulula nzile kutabala."
Ahi, "Ndatabala naiwe.
Naikiliza kyakubaijwa."

Kayabaile aliho omwelembo
Yatuluka Nyakalembe
Ahi Mukazi wange otekilweki aha?
Iluka ogende Katakubwa
Ogye onyihile eishoke ly'amabale
Ogende olete . . .ogende nabazana bange
Munkomele eli taba
Mukomelele emishenga myenda ibili

Yailuka Nyakalembe
*Lya Kabambagwa na Nyamwema*
*Bwoma butwalwa Kabagala*
Nabazana Katabubwa yagya omumabanga.

Yaiyayo eishoke lyamabale.
Yakoma etaba emishenga myenda ibili.

Olwo yasigile yagileta Nyakalembe
Nkabona ekitoke yatema *enyabwehogola* empambo ya kyolele.
Nkabona ekigando yakoma ekikulu.
Nkabona obukanda akaita emigono munana. (Yagenda zilimwo . . .)

shushushu
Yashobelwa Nyakalembe
*Lya Kabambagwa na Nyamwema*
Ati, "Omushaija wange aba *Kilwana* (maluke nyanga bwintambulaine)"
Ati, "Olwo yakugonza kutabala
Nkabona byona yabihika (omumaizi) omukwezi."
Ahi, "Mushaija wange!"
Ahi, "Kankwebugile (otabale) ntabale
Otaligenda. (Okaunge . . .)

PLOT OUTLINE

**Lines 390-5:**
The party sets out and journey's across the lake.

**Lines 396-411:**
Mugasha pauses on his journey to mediate a dispute between two villages and another one between two mountains by physically shoving them apart, changing the archaic landscape to its present form.

I heard Nyakalembe: "You are . . .

*He's gone before us in the wilderness–what do we fear?*
*In the wilderness, what do we fear?*
*In the wilderness, what do we fear?*
*In the wilderness, what do we fear?*

*I cooked.I preserved. I returned. I went.*

*Why wrap it up in cloth?*
*Because it will be chafed and stinging.*

*shushushu*
*Why wrap it up in cloth?*
*Because it will be chafed, be chafed, and stinging.*

*White one, you are joyful.*
*White one,you are joyful.*
*She is joyful in the reign.*
*She is joyful in the reign..*
*She is joyful in the reign.*
*She is joyful in the reign.*

He set out,the *Cloudburst*.
He set out, the *Urine thatis drunk*.
He set out, the *Germinator of crops.*

The canoe, he tossed into the Lake.
He pushed – no nature spirit paddled.
The current that took them from [Sesse] of Katanda
In Kanyangeleko it landed them . . .
In Kanyangeleko it landed them at Bukala.
He found them there
He stopped to mediate a case, Mugasha.

He found Kishaka and Lwazi villages
Had taken up their shields to finish one another off.
The way he planted his leg at Lwazi,
Lwazi retreated to upper Kanyangeleko Kingdom.
And Kishaka retreated to the water.
Those Kihanja mountains won't see each other again to fight.

Nkahulila Nyakalembe ("Oli . . .)

*Yayembeile omw'lungu nitutinamuki?*
*Omwilungu nitutinamuki?*
*Omwilungu nitutinamuki?*
*Omwilungu nitutinamuki?*

*Okuteka nkabiika nkagaluka nkagenda*

*Iliba ibindilwaki?*
*Iilikaitwa mishonga*

shushushu
*Iliba ibindilwaki?*
*Ilikaitwa, ilikaitwa mishonga*

*Kanyawela oyela*
*Kanyawela oyela*
*Nayela omungoma*
*Nayela omungoma*
*Nayela omungoma*
*Nayela omungoma*

Yasimbula *Lwanago*.
Yasimbula *Nkali enyobwa*.
Yasimbula *Luhingika bihambo*.

Obwato yabunaga omunyanja Lwelu
Yasindika-- Tibwabugilwe na mulanzi
Omushoke gwamwile Lya Katanda
Kanyangeleko gwamusola Bu-
Gwamusola Kanyangeleko Bukala
Yashangila baganganwa.
Akemelela kulamula Mugasha.

Ashanga Kishaka na Lwazi
Balonzile engabo kumalangana
Okugulu okwo yasimbile Lwazi,
Lwazi yashuba Kanyangeleko olugulu.
Kandi Kishaka yashuba omumaizi.
Kihanja tigalibonangana kulwana.

PLOT OUTLINE

**Lines 413-18.1:**
Then he creates five named places for people to draw water, the penultimate one also being associated with his wife.

**Lines 419-27:**
He stops to mediate the dispute of another pair of mountains.

**Lines 428-37:**
He happily continues on his journey, cutting passages between mountains and one across a river as he goes.

**Lines 438-53:**
He rests, asks his wife for his tobacco, and enjoys a smoke.

When he came to the Igogo river,
He found Mount Bugwantula,
My lord, and the Bean-spiller
Had taken up their shields to fight.
Mugasha stopped to mediate the mountains' case.
The way he planted his one leg,
Water came from Kabale –
Kyetema stream and Big-waters of the Ngogo.
He said, "Those Kihanja mountains won't see each other again to fight."

shushushu
In our section, he made a watering draw at the ford on the Ngogo.
He made a watering draw at Trench-sides ford and Carry-under-the-arm.
He made a watering draw at Leopard's place.

The place his wife passed,
The ford of Kilalama Kashekulo,
Is where Nyakalembe found her grinding stones.
My lord, when he arrived,
He made a watering draw at Lushala ford.

He found that Mubembe mountain
And the other one were fighting
He climbed the elder Mubembe . . .

He found the mountains of Kinoni and Mubembe
Had taken up their shields to fight.
He stopped to mediate the mountains' case, Mugasha.
The way he planted his one leg:
– Water's-roar is the ford of Kashokelo –
Those mountains won't see each other again to fight.

My lord, he cut the mountain of Bugabwa.
He cut the ford of Chalky-place.

He came to [the spirit medium] Lukebela's home in Bwigula.
He found he'd already sacrificed to the Catcher.
He found he'd already sacrificed to Precursor-of-the-cold,
And the Ever-satisfied one of Bwigula village.
What gladness took him from there!

He cut the mountain pass at Kilinzi village.
He stood at Fragrant-trees.
He climbed and came to Mayondwe.
Then he was greatly pleased. He sat, Mugasha.

Kayagile kwija omuli Igogo
Ashanga elya Bugwantula
Waitu nelya Ishesha mahelege
Galonzile engabo nigalwana.
Mugasha akemelela kulamula amabanga
Okugulu kwo yasimbile kumo:
Amaizi agalugile Kabale:
Niyo Kyetema nibyo Bizi bya Ngogo
Ahi Kihanja tigalibinangana kulwana

shushushu
Omwaitu yatabula omwalo gwa Ngogo

Yatabula ogwa ah- ogwa Nyamigongo na Kahaga(t)alwo

Yatabala Kemondo

Mbali omukaziwe yalabile
Ogwa Kibalama Kashekulo
Niyo Nyakalembe yalonzile ensheiso z'amabale.
Waitu kayagobile
Yatabula ogwa Lushala

Ashaga Mubembe
Na gonene nigalwana
Yatemba Mubembe lukulu

Ashanga elya Kinoni na Mubembe
Galonzile engabo kulwana
Akemelela kulamula amabanga Mugasha
Okugulu kwo yasimbile kumo:
Lubologa nigwo Mwalo gwa Kashokelo
Kayo tigalibonangana kulwana.

Waitu yatema elya Bugabwa
Yatema omwalo gwa Kinoni

Yaija omwa Lukebela Bwigula

Ashanga agabile Lukwata
Ashanga agabile Lwebembela milombe
Kaikala kaigusi(le) ka Bwigula
Amashemelelwa gamwihile aho.

Yatema empalo ya Kilinzi
Akema Nyamigaju
Yatemba yaija Mayondwe.
Mbali yashemeleilwe. Yashuntama Mugasha

PLOT OUTLINE

**Lines 454-74:**

He travels on toward the tree, cutting various named, water-related features into the earth.

He spoke to his wife, Nyakalembe.
He said, "Give me the tobacco rock-hair we wrapped in packets nine-times-two."
He said, "Since we left the lake I haven't had a smoke."
shushushu
Mugasha opened all the packets.
All the rock-hair made one pipefull.

He stood at Fragrant-trees.
Fire he ordered from Bwigula.

When he turned the bowl of his pipe,
From Kyegomola he reached its stem to Kagondo.
When he blew out smoke,
A mist enclosed Kihanja Kingdom.
My lord, when he closed his eyes in pleasure,
We saw the darkness fall.
He laughed a laugh and showed his teeth, provider–
My lord, the moon shone down on Bwigula.
He said, "But I've come, of course, to battle with Muhata."

In the place he sat to rest – Kaboya – he placed a stream.
He cut Busheleka stream.
He cut Bwanja.
The road brought him up to the seasonal swamp at Shabani's place–
Where his serving girls danced singing in a circle
Formed by Kyenshushe and Kashozi mountains near Maziba and Mayondwe villages.

shushushu
He made the watering place of Nyamilembe and Biina.
He cut Pouring-water and Lugege.
He cut Tying-up and Little-packages.
"I'll go to Itoju village and report."

And at the shrine of Mugasha
He cut Kyamugasha (Water's flow).
He cut Dog-eater.
He cut Old Lungfish.
He cut Kayoya.
He hurried and made the waters at Where-did-it-come-from.
My lord, it is the pond at Itoju village.
He descended to Little-streams.
He made the watering draw at Ntabo.

Akagamba omukaziwe Nyakalembe
Ahi, "Mpa etaba eishoke ly'amabale elyo twakomile emishenga myenda ebili
Ahi kuluga ndugile omunyanja tinkanyoileo taba na gumo
shushushu
Emishenga yashala yona Mugasha
Eishoke ly'amabale yata ihembe limo

Akema Nyamigaju.
Omulilo yatanza Bwigula.

Kayakubwile akabunu k'eiyembe
Kyegolomola olusheke yasimba Kagondo.
Kayamakwile omwika
Kihanja oluho lukabamba.
Waitu, kayabunize amaisho.
Tubona omwilima gwatobela.
Ensheko eyo yashekile omumaino Lugaba
Waitu omwezi gwajaguta Bwigula
Ahi, "Manti nzile kulwana na Muhata."

Mbali yashuntamile kwikya Kaboya yataho akaiga.
Yatema Busheleka.
Yatema Bwanja.
Embalabala yamutembwile lutunga lw'omwa Shabani

Mbali abazanabe balibasile mbahooya batazile
Olubuga Kyenshushe niko Kashozi ka Maziba na Mayondwe

shushushu
Yatabula ogwa Nyamilembe na Biina
Yatema Kyamukwikwi na Lugege
Yatema Nkomelo na Butanda
"Kangende Itoju mbalule"

Namwonene kyanga kya Mugasha
Yatema Kyamugasha
Yatema Lulyambwa
Yatema Mamba nkulu
Yataema Kayoya
Yailuka yatabula agomwa Kikalugaha

Waitu niko kanyanja ka Itoju
Yasoka Kaiga
Yatabula Ntabo

PLOT OUTLINE

**Lines 475-83:**
Mugasha sees the tree apparently fleeing towards the south and proceeds in that direction, creating water sources as he goes.

**Lines 484-98:**
When he reaches the close vicinity of the tree he sends it first a butterfly-messenger then his named winds, which make the tree reel as though drunk.

**Lines 499-510:**
Mugasha then he approaches and plants his foot, creating more water sources as he does so.

The place he truly played at
Was the seasonal swamp of Kabakimbo–
Where his wife, Nyakalembe awaited him–
And the pond of Pasturage at the home of
He-who-is-not-roared-at.

At Katoke he cut the seasonal swamp of Heart's-end.
He made the watering draw at I-agree.
In Ihangiro he made the watering draw in the gully at
Muyenje.

He sighted the tree as it fled toward Buzinja.
He set out on the lake at Rwazi.
He started toward Shoshwa Island and Mazinga

When he had been keeping it before him,
When he'd come to border of Ihagiro Kingdom,
He made a draw on the river of May-they-tell-the-tale, my kings.
It is the very Boundary-keeper of Buzinja and Ihangiro.

shushushu
He cut the waters of Self-seconder in Itongo,
And from Self-seconder he came to Muleba.

When he reached Muleba,
In the seasonal marshes there,
He sighted the Mafumbo tree.
– As you and I are: Mugasha was that close –
He released the Butterfly,
"Go lie among the branches
And say this, 'Cook my porridge fast. It won't have time to cool.
This day he'll lie at Lulama.
Look behind you – here comes Mugasha.
His butterfly already flits among your branches.
Mugasha has not come to play with the Muhata tree.'"

When he saw the little one clutch the tree
He released the *enshungu* wind of Bugabo.
The *omuyanja* wind of Machunda's home.
The *omwilombe* wind from Sesse
The *nkomaizi* wind from [Buzinja].
They went "Ya-a-a"
And shook the tree until it reeled as though drunk.

When he had the *Adze-conqueror* reeling drunk,
He planted his foot to uproot the tree,
He planted it there at Copper village.

Mbali yabaile nazana bwoli
Nko katunga ka Kabakimbo
Mbali omukaziwe yamulindile Nyakalembe
Nko kanyanja ka Bushumba omwa Lutahindwa.

Katoke yatema olwa Kiwamwoyo
Yatabula aga Nyamukunda
Ihangilo yatabula Olusa lwa Muyenje

Yagulengela gwashuba Buzinja
Akasabalila Lwazi
Yayema Shoshwa na Mazinga

Olwo yabaile naija nagufunya
Olwo yaizile Ihagilo omugati
Yatabula omwiga owa Kabagana bakama bange

Nigwo Muhingo gwa Buzinja na Ihangilo

shushushu
Yatema aga Kyeshongela Itongo.
Akema Kyeshongela yaija Muleba.

Olwo Yakamazile kwija Muleba
Omuntunga za Muleba
Yalengela omuti gwa Mafumbo
Nkaiwe nanye Mugasha
Yataishula Kayoiyo
"Ogye ogulale omumashanju
Ogil' ohi, 'Chumbachumba obwange tibumpolela.

Kileki nakulala Lulama.
Nobona oku enyuma. Naija Mugasha.
Kolabona akayoiyo kahingula omuli ogu.
Tinakwija kuzana na Muhata.'"

Kayasigile kagukwata
Yataishula enshungu Bugabo
Omuyanja kakauka omwa Machunda
Omwilombe gwaiya Isheshe
Enkomaizi yaiya (Bugabo) Buzinja
Ngu yaa
Yachunda gwagya omutamilo

Olwo yasigile gwatamila *Alemile ababaizi*
Okugulu kwo yasimbile kunyukula omuti ogwo
Akakusimba Lwamilinga

PLOT OUTLINE

**Lines 511-22:**
He grasps the tree, plucks it out, holds its roots up to the sun, and thrusts the branches downward into the earth (lines 511-16). Mugasha makes sure the tree will never grow again and then sets off to report to King Rugomora.

**Lines 523-48:**
Mugasha travels along toward Rugomora's palace, creating water sources, two rocky outcrops — traditional locales for palaces, and a well-known impression of his foot in stone.

The water that springs from that place is Rushing-sound,
Is Pouring, is Kyabakoba Seen-by-few,
Is Kalebe and Kyanyabasa.
He cut Kansinda stream, the water source at Nkenge.
In Kafunjo village at Thin-man's home in Kiziba
The waters met to come to Shangano.
They flowed to the west.

He planted his foot in the direction of Buzinja of Nshanshame.
The water that sprung forth from there forms Buligi pond.
The river that swings from side to side from there is the Muleleizi,
Which descends and becomes the Earth-mover and Blood River,
And which descends to Byakalemela, my kings.

The way he planted his single foot . . .

Extending one arm out into Muleba's marshes,

Holding the tree by its branches,
He lifted it up and out completely, to its very roots.
Its branches he showed to the sun
Its roots he showed to the sun.
Then he thrust the branches downward.
He turned them towards the earth.
He said, "I'll cut down what could not be chopped by living being."

When he went to look at how to cut the tree,
He rinsed it with a pouring rain.
"I'll wash the roots," he said. "They'll never grow again."
He placed a river where he plucked it out.
"I'll go up to Kihanja and report.
I'll go and report to Rugomora."

He cut between Kitabi village and Mujunwa
And Kashaka and the Leprous snakes of Nyakalando.
At Onion village the place he sat to rest
Became Bulembo stream on the mountain.
– That mountain made him tired, Mugasha –
He made his ascent to Nyawaibaga.
He shuffled through the valley that starts from there and goes to Itongo.
The place he sat down to rest
Became Kahunguhungu spring in Itongo.

Amaizi galugilemu niyo Kyezingola niyo Kishala
Niyo Lushesha niyo Kyabakoba Nyakabonwa-bake
Niyo Kalebe na Kyanyabasa
Yatema Kansinda nigo maizi ga Nkenge
Kafunjo omwa Kashaija Kana Kiziba
Gatelana kugya Shangano
Gwashuile obugwaizoba

Akagusimba Buzinja Bwa Nshanshame lubaju olu

Amaizi galugilemu niko kanyanja ka Buligi
Omwiga ogwatazilaho nigwo mwiga gwa Muleleizi

Gwasoka nigwo Kitinde na Lwamba

Gwasoka kwija Byakalemela bakama bange

Olwo yasimbile okugulu omukumo...
Interruption
Yatuma okukono gumo akema Ihangilo omuntunga za Muleba
Yagukola omumashunju
Yashutula gwona, gwawa omumizi.
Amashanju yagoleka omwa kazoba
Emizi yagyoleka omwa kazoba
Yateneka amashunju
Yagaluka omwitaka
Ahi, "Kanteme tigulishenywa mulola."

Kayaizile kuleba okwo yatema omuti ogwo
Yakenena enjula lwanago
Ngwogy'emizi. Gutalishuba kumela.
Yatekama omwiko (omwiga) mbali yagunyukwile.
Kantembe Kihanja mbalule.
Ngende kubalulila Lugomola."

Yatema Kitabi na Mujunwa
Na Kakasha n'enjoka ibembya za Nyakalando.
Katungulu mbali yashuntamile kwikya
Niko kaiga ka Bulembo omwibanga.
Eibanga lyamulenga Mugasha
Akatembukila Nyawaibaga
Yasoleza oluhanga lwalugile aho lwaija lwagoba Itongo

Mbali yashuntamile kwikya
Niyo nchulo ya Kahunguhungu Itongo

PLOT OUTLINE

**Lines 549-75:**

He behaves recklessly at the court (lines 549-50) but creates another rocky outcrop for the royal aristocrats (lines 551-54). He continues on toward Lake Victoria, creating water sources as he goes.

He cut the rocky outcrops at Lutega's home.
He hurried along and cut the waters of Bugoma.
He cut the waters of Nyabwetangale.
He cut the marsh of Nyabwilulilo.
He cut the waters of Nyamakonjwa.
– Kamachumu had not yet become a town –
He made the spring of Kamilabala flow.
My lord, he cut Lwachwilebitaba stream.
At our place – let me not mislead you –
He cut the waters of Sandy-stream.
He cut thewaters of Short-arm, provider.
At Itunzi village he cut Canoe-smasher in Bugenda village.
My lord, he cut the marsh of . . .
He made the watering draw of Kishalu
Where his wife got white clay,
The *Beautifier of milk pots*.

"Let me report to Rugomora."

He cut Short-arm stream.
He hurried along and cut Katunga marsh.
He left his footprints there to tell the story.

At King Rugomora's forecourt in our own Ibale, he knocked together the royal gateposts.
He uprooted all the plantain plants in Kagabilo
And from there he strolled without a care to our home.
The forecourt is the Bugonzi river.

The place he sat to rest in the royal forecourt of Kagembo.
He set his bow and quiver down
And dug a rocky outcrop, my kings,
The Hinda's rocky outcrop in the royal forecourt.

The place that he descended now is the Columns of Mugasha,
Where his wife Nyakalembe observed,
"We came here once in the rains,
But now the dry season has turned to drought."
So he struck his one foot,
And water sprung out there at Kagasha village:
Muleleizi stream flowed down to the Elephant-swallower river.

Yatema ebyazi byomwa Lutega.
Yailuka yatema aga Bugoma.
Yatema aga Nyabwetangale.
Yatema olutunga lwa Nyabwilulilo.
Yatema aga Nyamakonjwa.
Kamachumu etakabaile mujini.
Yatabulamu akachulo ka Kamilabala.
Waitu yatema Lwachwilebitaba.
Omwaitu ntakulembalemba bwoli
Yatema aga Nyakashenye.
Yatema aga Kakono Lugaba.
Itunzi yatema Kyatamato Buganda.
Waitu yatema omutunga lwa . . .
Yatabula aga Kishalu
Mbali omukaziwe yahile eitaka lilikwela lya Kibumba
Buzima lushemeza byanzi

Kangende mbalulile Lugomola

Yatema Kakona
Yailuka yatema Katunga
Nimwo yasingile ebilenge kubalula

Mwaitu Ibale yakwatanisa ebiti byamalembo omw'omukama Lugomola
Engemu yainyukula yamalila Kagabilo
Mbali yabaile natalanga omwaitu
Omwaitu omwilembo nigwo mwiga gwa Bugonzi

Mbali yashuntamile kwaikya Nyalulembo Kagembo
Yataho obutai nekilimba
Yalimaho olwazi bakama bange
Nibyo byazi byabahinda Nyalulembo

Mbali yakongokeile nizo nyomyo za Mugasha

Mbali mukaziwe yamubaza Nyakalembe
Ahi, "Maha kunu tukaija eli toigo
Ekyanda nka (kya)lwahinduka luhato."
Akatela okugulu kumo
Amaizi agalugile Kagasha
Muleleizi gasoka kwija Kamila-Njoju

PLOT OUTLINE

**Lines 576-97:**

Mugasha passes through Rwija and knocks down another famous tree of sacrifices (lines 576-80.1). He continues toward the west, passing through landmark villages to the Kingdom of Karagwe, pausing at the king's palace at Bwelanyange to behave a bit recklessly and then continue on towards Rwanda.

He was brought by the low road at Kwesigabo's place.
He cut Mugalika stream.
The River Kamaiile bubbled up.
He cut the water at Komwangushu's home.
At the home of Mister-Big at Lutete.
He made the water of Kashangula flow.
He hurried along and cut the water of Kanamile.
The water that flows to the west
Arrives at Kimaka watering draw in Nyakigando.

That day – Let me not lead you astray –
The water ran down – Let me not lead you astray –
Ran down to Mikoni stream.
He hurried along to Tabooed-hoe village where water flows from a cleft.
He crossed over and came to Rwija.

He found Strength-eater tree, which had long stood there,
The *mutoma* tree of Rwija.
He aimed his foot at it. It fell.
In Kyamutwara Kingdom they respect not what they see.
They said Strength-eater did not fall, my kings.
It merely lay down on its back to rest.

He made Rwija rocky outcrop a watering place.
He descended to the Nyakijuganwa fields in Kafunjo
Where he stayed four days.
. . at Ikimba lake.

The place his wife placed her feet
Became Kashwa and Kajunje.
He did not lie there, the *Cloudburst*.
He took the road to Bwelanyange village.

Sesse, Kailongo, Luhunga villages,
Mugajwale and Kakalonto villages.
He walked to Kabwenge
And was taken by the road to Lukoma.

When he reached Karagwe's plantain groves
He cut the grassy waterway at Bujuluga.
At Bwelanyange at the Muhinda's home, he knocked gateposts together.
"I've come to report," he said.
He finished his business and did not sleep there.
He set out toward Rwanda.

Akaletwa empalo yomwa Kwesigabo
Yatema Mugalika
Omwiga yatabula Kamaiile
Yatema agomwa Komwangushu
Omwa Bwana Mukulu Lutete
Yatabula amaizi ga Kashangula
Yailuka yatema aga Kanamile
Agalebile omukono gw'obugwa izoba
Nigo gaizile kwija Kimaka Nyakigando

Ntakulembalemba kilekyo
Agasokile ntakulemba
Agasokeile Mikoni
Yailuka yaija Kazila-nfuka ndw'olutanda

Yashabuka yaija Lwija

Akashanga kalyaigala eyemeleile
Nigwo mutoma gwa Lwija
Akagulengaho ebilenge gukakumba
Kyamutwala bahela ebyobabona
Bahi Kalyaigala tiyakumbile bakama bange
Ekatekaho omugongo kwikya

Yatabula aga kyazi kya Lwija
Yakongoka Nyakijuganwa Kafunjo
Mbali yamazile ebilo bina
Ekija mbaleba nyanja ya Ikimba

Mbali omukaziwe yagataile
Niyo Kashwa na Kashunje
Talalaileo Lwanago
Yakwata Bwelanyange bwoli

Nsheshe Kailongo Luhunga
Mugajwale na Kakalondo
Yalibata Kabwenge
Akatwalwa omuhanda gwa Lukoma

Olwo yagobile Kalagwe ahangemu
Yatema akafunjo ka Bujuluga
Bwelanyange yakwatanisa ebiti byamalembo namwo mw'Omuhinda
"Nzile kubalula"
Yamala talalailema
Yashabuka yagya Rwanda

PLOT OUTLINE

**Lines 598-609.1:**

In Rwanda he creates the headwaters of the Kagera River and travels down it to his home in Lake Victoria.

The leg that faced the west
Became the water that flows to Bugege.
And the water that descends into Kigali
That goes eastward toward the Lake
Is the Kagera river, the high road to Kyambagaza,
My lord, the way that brought him
Straightways to Nkenge.
He descended at the home of Thin-man.
There he is at Lukunyu landing
Where the Kagera steps into Lake Victoria.
The river it was that brought him to the Sesse Islands.
The floating plants you see in the Kagera that do not travel
Are like serving maidens who welcome a traveler from Rwanda.

Muzee's wife: You've worked hard.
Mzee: I did, but I refused to say where it came from.

Okugulu kwalebile obugwaizoba
Nigo maizi gagile Bugege
Agobukongokelo kugya Kigali
Ogwalebile omukono gw'obugwa nyanja
Kagela niyo mbalabala ya Kyabangaza
Waitu nigwo mukono gwamulesile
Yata gumo kwija Nkenge
Yasoka omwa Kashaija kana
Niwogu yaija Lukunyu
Kagela yalibata Lwelu
Ngwo mwiga gwamulesile Isheshe
Obwonge bwobona Kagela obutosha
Mbo bazana bamutangilele agile Rwanda

Mke: Okagubona mahyo
Mzee: Nkagubona mawe nkagubona. Nayanga kugamba mbali gwabaile gwemeleile